

sites. And don't forget the customs duty either, which can be pretty hefty.

Buying in India

For you techno freaks out there who simply must get your hands on the Nomad II MP3 player as soon as it is released, the best solution is still to purchase it from abroad. If however, like most people, you want to ensure that you can avail of after sales assistance in India, you should stick to the Indian distributors for these products.

Most of the brands already present in India, such as Sony and Kodak for digital cameras and Creative and D-Link for MP3 players, offer these products through the same dealers and distributors that already offer computers and peripherals. The availability, however, is quite unpredictable and the prices tend to be on the higher side. Some retail stores stock these products as well.

A few Indian sites that allow you to purchase digital products online have also made an appearance recently. Fabmart.com has a section that offers computers and related products. You can pay for the products in rupees or with an Indian credit card, which is pretty convenient. Products are shipped to you via courier, though charges vary according to products and locations.

In time you will probably be able to purchase directly from the manufacturer's own stores. Compaq, among others, has an online store



I finally managed to buy the digital camera I wanted at a huge electronics market in Saudi Arabia
[Steven D'Souza](#)
Technology Enthusiast

(Cooldukan.com), which offers laptops and desktop computers. You can expect these sites to eventually start offering products such as the iPaq, online.

As new brands and models enter the Indian market, life will become easier and competition will also help drive prices down. Either way, its obvious that things are beginning to get very interesting for all of us gadget freaks! So the next time you go shopping for a gadget, shop wisely. And there just might be times when lady luck smiles down upon you, as she did on Kersi Aga, co-founder of the Indian Palm User Group (IPUG), who was introduced to the Palm when his father picked up one from a shop. "As he was not using it much, I proceeded to fiddle around and got hooked on to it!"

Now if only we were all so lucky! 

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